Exam stress among university students: a cross-sectional survey

Abstract

Background: Exam stress is common among university students. Methods: This cross-sectional survey included 240 students. Results: Two in five reported high stress. Conclusion: Support services should be strengthened.

Keywords

stress; students; survey; mental health

Introduction

Stress affects academic performance (Chen and Park, 2021). Garcia et al. (2022) linked exam stress to poor sleep [3], and loneliness adds to it (Nguyen, 2021).

Support services can help (Brown 2020; Kumar, 2022) [4].

Methods

This cross-sectional survey was conducted between August 2024 and November 2024 at a public university. A total of 240 students (n = 240) took part. Inclusion criteria were enrolment in an undergraduate programme; exclusion criteria were incomplete responses.

Stress was measured with a validated questionnaire, provided as Supplementary File 1.

The study was approved by the University Research Ethics Committee (approval no. UREC/2024/077, dated 2 July 2024). Written informed consent was obtained from all participants.

Results

High stress was reported by 41% of students (Table 1; Figure 1).

Discussion

Our results agree with earlier surveys (Brown, 2020).

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Conflicts of interest

The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

Author contributions

AB: conceptualisation, analysis. CD: data collection, writing.

Data availability statement

Data are available from the corresponding author on reasonable request.

Figure 1. Stress scores by year of study.

Table 1. Participant characteristics.

Variable

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